Ascentis
ESOL Skills for Life

First Name	Surname	Date of Birth

Centre Name

Reading
Level 2

Guide time: 100 minutes

Practice Paper A

ASESOLR02/PPA

Assessment Criteria	Tick if achieved
1.1	
1.2	
1.3	
1.4	
2.1	
3.1	
3.2	

Instructions
- You must use a pen - black or blue ink.
- Dictionaries may not be used.
- There are 4 tasks to be completed**.** Answer all questions.

Pass mark	14/21
Mark	

	Date Task Completed		Assessor	IQA
Task 1		Name		
		Signature		
		Date		
Task 2		Name		
		Signature		
		Date		
Task 3		Name		
		Signature		
		Date		
Task 4		Name		
		Signature		
		Date		

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Text 1

Read this work-based text about dealing with clients who are deaf/hearing impaired.

1 Your new job role requires you to deal with members of the public. Many requests come from people who have a hearing loss or impairment. How do you communicate with them?

2 Our work is important and we all need to make sure that we help our clients. You need to be ready to communicate with all potential customers, including those with hearing loss or impairments but you have not learned sign language. With over 10 million people in the UK having some form of hearing loss, maybe we should all learn to sign?

3 In the meantime, how do you communicate without signing? We asked experts in this field to give us some advice and they recommended a number of strategies. The first is to be patient. With time, it is possible to communicate with everyone.

4 When communicating with someone who has some form of hearing loss follow these points:

- Make sure that you face them and they are also connecting with you eye-to-eye.
- Get their attention before speaking, as they may be distracted, wave to them, for example.
- If they are veiled, eye contact is still essential so face them directly so they can see you fully.

5 Secondly, speak clearly and a little slowly; it is not necessary to enunciate every single syllable or raise your voice. Keep your language simple, try to avoid jargon and long explanations. Use gestures and try to speak as ‘naturally’ as possible. If possible, try to make sure that you are having the discussion in an area where there aren’t many distractions, and there is good lighting. This helps the person you are in communication with to avoid distractions by other movements or activities.

6 If there is an interpreter with the person you are talking to, make sure that you face the person rather than the interpreter; the interpreter doesn’t want the advice for themselves, they need it for the deaf person. If you are communicating with a group of people, some of whom are hearing impaired, make sure to make eye contact with all, and not just with those who can hear.

7 So it’s clearly quite simple. Finally, make sure you communicate as ‘naturally’ as possible, repeat only if asked to do so and listen to the person who has a hearing loss rather than the interpreter. If you really want to show how committed you are to communicating with people with hearing impairment- go and learn sign language!

Task 1 (Guide time 25 minutes)

Read Text 1 and answer questions 1–5.

Your answers must be based on information in the text.

1 What is the best title for the text?

Tick one box ☑

a Communicating with people with a hearing loss / impairment ☐

b The reasons for learning sign language ☐

c The nature of communication ☐

d The importance of making eye contact ☐

2 According to the text, when communicating with someone who has a veil and hearing loss, it's important to:

Tick one box ☑

a make sure you are looking at them ☐

b avoid looking at them ☐

c try to distract them ☐

d use lots of gestures ☐

3 Write the word or phrase in the fifth paragraph that means the same as **'articulate every sound'.**

_____

4 The main purpose of this text is to:

Tick one box ☑

a discuss the general problems of communication ☐

b offer advice about communicating with people with hearing loss ☐

c highlight the importance of learning sign language ☐

d argue about the importance of eye contact when communicating. ☐

5 When communicating with people with hearing loss, you should:

Tick one box ☑

a speak in a loud voice ☐

b wave at them all the time ☐

c repeat everything you say ☐

d try to speak as you usually would ☐

Question	Assessment Criteria	Achieved ✓ / X
1	1.1	
2	1.3	
3	1.4	
4	2.1	
5	3.1	
Total Marks /5		

Text 2

You are going to read some advice from consumer rights experts on an online forum about your legal rights for returning faulty goods.

Forum

Home Thread >> E-readers

Surjit	12/01/14 14:41 The washing machine's broken only 7 months after I bought it online. What can I do? email pm block
Abbie	12/01/14 16:50 It's very important for all of us to know that we are protected when shopping under the Sale of Goods Act 1979, even if we have bought something online. This means that you and the seller have agreed a contract, so you expect them to provide you with goods that work over a reasonable length of time. You do have a 14-day 'cooling off' period when you can return something you bought online without giving a reason. The next thing that you need to remember is that under this Act, if there are any faults within 6 months of purchase, it is the seller's responsibility to sort this out. For you, the problem is that number 7. The law says that if anything is faulty within 6 months of you buying it, the seller has to do something and you've had your washing machine for longer than 6 months. email pm block
Surjit	12/01/14 16:50 So what can I do? I can't help it that it broke after 7 months and not 6! email pm block
Fan	12/01/14 16:50 Don't worry, there is something called the 'Limitations Act' that also protects you if you've gone over the 6 month time period. What's important to consider is that the longer you have a product, the more difficult it is to prove that the machine was faulty when you bought it. I can't believe it's broken after just 7 months but these things do happen. But I do think that 7 months for a washing machine is different from having it 17 months and then it broke! It's reasonable if something stops working after 17 months, but not really 7! So what I suggest you do is try and get in touch with the seller and explain what's happened – either by email or phone. Most sellers are quite reasonable nowadays and will, I'm sure, help you out.

	email	pm	block
Oliver	12/01/14 16:50 I totally agree with Fan and I'd just like to add another option you may have, which is warranty. If your machine's under a warranty, and most retailers include at least 1 year's warranty on things like washing machines, you can go back to the seller and ask them to solve this for you. If they tell you it is the manufacturer's responsibility, just contact the manufacturer. Because the machine is within the year's warranty, they have to fix the problem or even replace the machine. Just don't get discouraged by what they say – you are in the right and if you're polite but firm, the seller or manufacturer will deal with this.		
	email	pm	block
Surjit	12/01/14 16:50 Ok, thanks. I'll email them now.		
	email	pm	block

Task 2 (Guide time 25 minutes)

Read Text 2 and answer questions 1-5.

Your answers must be based on information in the text.

1 Who shows surprise that the washing machine has broken down after 7 months?

_____

2 Whose reply contains information about buying goods online?

_____

3 Write down the word in Oliver's reply that means the same as **'guarantee'.**

_____

4 According to the texts, when goods break after we have bought them, what protects us?

Tick one box ☑

a The law ☐

b The sellers promise ☐

c The manufacturer's reassurance ☐

d Advice from consumer rights experts ☐

5 Whose replies are optimistic about what 'Surjit' can do? Give **two** answers.

- _____
- _____

Question	Assessment Criteria	Achieved ✓ / X
1	1.3	
2	3.2	
3	1.4	
4	3.1	
5	3.2	
Total Marks /5		

Text 3

Why do so many prisoners who have served their time go on to reoffend when they are released? This is a question that many politicians debate time and again, particularly when there is an increased demand for prison places due to the number of sentences given to prisoners.

Recent reports in the media have questioned the role of prisons. There is no doubt that we, as a society, need to recognise that certain actions are crimes, and that the individuals who commit crimes need to be punished. Every country in the world defines what it sees as a criminal activity, and gives fitting punishments according to its own laws. Whether we agree with these punishments is not the purpose of this article, nor are we examining the reasons for these crimes (although it is essential that we recognise that individuals may commit crimes due to societal pressures). What we discuss here is the nature of the punishments across different cultures, when a crime in one country is considered to be proof that we are a civilised society in another.

An approach to punishment taken by many Scandinavian countries, which is modelled in countries across Europe is that of open prisons. In the UK, open prisons house those who have committed less serious crimes or a minority who have committed serious crimes and who are now at the end of their sentence. The purpose of these prisons is to trust the inmates to act responsibly.

In Norway, the attitude towards punishment is liberal compared to the UK. The attitude towards criminals is to treat them as individuals who will want to take responsibility for their lives once released. Respect for the individual is evident because the view is that if you treat the offender with respect, they will learn to respect themselves, and thus not to be tempted to a life of crime on release. So how is this achieved?

Prisoners in an open prison live in small communities with their own rooms with TVs and computers. They are offered training, education and opportunities to work. They can leave the prison area to work and study, and have free time to fish or swim if they wish to. With their wages, prisoners can buy and cook their own food as they are only provided with one daily meal. There is even a garden for them to grow their own food. There is a sense of community as the prisoners are responsible for looking after their own living areas, from fixing things to painting the outside.

So what is the punishment, you may ask if they are able to study, work and do whatever they enjoy? The reality is the prisoners are not free. They cannot go and live freely in society and this is the real punishment. And the effects? The opportunity to be an active member of society on release, and for Norway, the lowest reoffending rate in Europe.

Task 3 (Guide time 25 minutes)

Read Text 3 and answer questions 1–6.

Your answers must be based on information in the text.

1 What is the best title for this text?

Tick one box ☑

a Life is an open prison in Norway ☐

b Petty or serious crimes – what is the difference? ☐

c Reducing reoffending rates – are open prisons the answer? ☐

d What is a crime? ☐

2 According to the text, there is no worldwide agreement on what constitutes a crime.

Tick one box ☑

True ☐

False ☐

3 Write down the word in the fourth paragraph that means the same as **'open-minded'.**

_____

4 In Norway, what is the punishment for those in open prisons?

Tick one box ☑

a They have no work to afford their food? ☐

b They have to maintain their own accommodation ☐

c They have to study and train ☐

d They have lost their liberty ☐

5 What describes the writer's attitude to open prisons?

Tick one box ☑

a Negative ☐

b Positive ☐

c Dismissive ☐

d Critical ☐

6 Open prisons are the only reason for Norway having the lowest reoffending rates in Europe?

Tick one box ☑

True ☐

False ☐

Question	Assessment Criteria	Achieved ✓ / X
1	1.1	
2	1.2	
3	1.4	
4	1.3	
5	3.2	
6	1.2	
Total Marks /6		

Text 4

With the fast pace in technology these days, it's difficult to keep up to date with everything. In this issue, we look at useful mobile phone and computer apps and hobbies, like gardening. So how can apps help you with gardening or cooking? A new app suitable for all types of smartphones claims to do just this– link our favourite hobbies of gardening or baking with our phones.

Gardening is tiring, but it's also fun. Being out in the fresh air, working with nature and seeing the results of your hard work at the end of the day is extremely satisfying. Baking is a chance for you to be creative and the end result is delicious. But imagine you are out in the garden ready to work hard, and your gardening tools break or you are in the kitchen, all ingredients prepared, and the equipment breaks down. What do you do? Wait until you can get the tools fixed or buy a new one? That may take some time, so here is another suggestion.

Download the 'gardn4evr' or 'bake4evr' app and you will be able to see if there is someone with tools nearby who is willing to lend theirs to you for a small fee. It is a clever idea and will appeal to gardening fanatics everywhere. So how does it work?

When you first download and open the app, you are asked if you agree to offer your tools for hire. You must click ''yes'' to continue further. After clicking ''yes'', you are asked to complete a section with your personal details and list the tools you have to offer for hire. There is a guide for the cost of hire for all types of tools to help you price your items. Once you have priced your tools, you are asked to specify the area you are willing to share tools in, so you are not travelling 5 miles to pick up a tool. When this is complete and you set up payment details, you can make use of the app.

When trying this app, we found that it was best to keep the area very local. Restricting the area to your street and perhaps the next street is best as you can pick up a tool quickly and continue working in the garden. The list of tools available can be limited so some tools we were using were not available for hire. Some gardeners didn't like this. However, when it worked, it was great! Payment is all online so carrying cash was unnecessary and, as an added bonus, it meant we learnt who the neighbours were, and we have become a friendlier neighbourhood since we all used this app.
We wonder if the idea of this app can be improved by asking people to offer gardening or baking services to their neighbours as well. Perhaps if the elderly couple from number 55 are struggling to maintain their garden, or they have an anniversary coming up and want a special cake, they can ask for help from their neighbourhood. Children can be encouraged to offer their services by watering the plants or helping to look after gardens. In return, the elderly couple can enjoy a beautiful garden and get to know their neighbours at the same time.

Task 4 (Guide time 25 minutes)

Read Text 4 and answer questions 1–5.

Your answers must be based on information in the text.

1 What sentence provided the best summary of the second paragraph?

Tick one box ☑

a Gardening if you have the right equipment provides a lot of enjoyment ☐

b Growing your own fruit is rewarding ☐

c The right tools are necessary for gardening ☐

d An app can make gardening or baking easier ☐

2 You need to offer tools for hire to use this app.

Tick one box ☑

True ☐

False ☐

3 According to the text, there is a wide variety of tools on offer.

Tick one box ☑

True ☐

False ☐

4 The purpose of the text is:

Tick one box ☑

a to sell ☐

b to guide ☐

c to review ☐

d to advertise ☐

5 Overall the writer's impression of the app is that it:

Tick one box ☑

a has a lot of potential ☐

b is useless ☐

c is the best idea for bakers ☐

d can lead to disputes ☐

END OF ASSESSMENT

Question	Assessment Criteria	Achieved ✓ / X
1	1.1	
2	3.1	
3	1.2	
4	2.1	
5	2.1	
Total Marks /5		

Ofqual Accreditation Number

Ascentis Level 2 Certificate in ESOL Skills for Life - 601/4083/5

Ascentis Level 2 Award in ESOL Skills for Life (Reading - 601/4272/8